

» CHEQUERED FLAG

WRAPPING IT UP IN STYLE

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The Abu Dhabi Grand Prix was more than just another season-finale race. As the ceremonial fireworks lit up the Yas Marina Circuit's main straight, they marked the culmination of intense rivalries, heartfelt farewells, and moments of triumph.

The paddock buzzed with emotions, from celebrating a long-awaited championship to the quiet reflections of those preparing for new challenges and bittersweet goodbyes. The 2024 Formula One season, a 24-race spectacle that reignited competitiveness and brought back on-track excitement and off-track drama, had come to an end.

Mega win for McLaren

Taking the chequered flag for the fourth and final time this year was Lando Norris, who executed McLaren's mission to reclaim the Constructors' Championship after 26 years with a near-perfect race. Despite starting on the back foot, the team found its footing and, from there on, charged ahead and never looked back.

The 666 points McLaren collected over the nine-odd months

represented more than just the six race wins, 21 podium finishes, and eight fastest-lap points. The Woking-based unit managed to score every weekend, with second-placed Norris (374) leading the way and his teammate Oscar Piastri just behind (292).

The Australian, in only his second full season, proved to be the consistency factor McLaren needed. He finished outside the top 10 only once but completed every single lap — all 1,444 of them — becoming only the fourth driver ever to do so. While Norris' ambition of stealing the crown from eventual champion Max Verstappen fell through, his team's coronation more than compensated for it. McLaren took 17 rounds — after the Azerbaijan Grand Prix — to leapfrog Red Bull, which struggled